

Guda Abignan Reddy

+91-8919380958 | abhignan.2003@gmail.com | Nellore, AP, India

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity professional with hands-on SOC experience investigating, triaging, and responding to enterprise security incidents using Microsoft Defender XDR, Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Office 365, Defender for Cloud Apps, and Microsoft Threat Intelligence. Skilled in SIEM engineering, cloud security, email and identity threat investigation, and AI-driven threat detection, with a track record of independently managing incidents end-to-end — from identification through resolution and customer communication. Experience extends to building production-grade honeypot environments on Microsoft Azure, deploying open-source SIEM stacks with Wazuh, and engineering an LLM-powered cyber guardian bot with automated incident response. Seeking to grow as a SOC Analyst / Security Engineer, bringing hands-on expertise in threat validation, incident response, and threat intelligence to a world-class security team.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Operations & Incident Response: SOC Analysis, Security Operations, Security Monitoring, Incident Response, Threat Intelligence, Cyber Threat Intelligence (CTI), Cyber Threat Hunting (CTH), Security Intelligence, Email Security, Digital Forensics, Malware Analysis, Log Analysis, Vulnerability Assessment, Penetration Testing, Ethical Hacking

Cloud, Microsoft Security & Tools: Microsoft Defender XDR (MDX), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Office 365 (MDO), Microsoft Defender for Cloud Apps (MDCA), Microsoft Threat Intelligence (MTI), Microsoft Entra ID, Azure Sentinel, Microsoft Azure, Cloud Security, Log Analytics Workspace, Jira, Wazuh, Splunk, KQL, Wireshark, Nmap, Metasploit, Burp Suite, GeoIP Watchlists

Programming & Operating Systems: Python, Bash Scripting, MySQL, HTML/CSS, Git, Linux (CLI & Administration), Windows Security

Frameworks & AI: MITRE ATT&CK, OWASP Top 10, CIA Triad, LangChain, LLM Integration, Machine Learning (scikit-learn), OpenCV

EXPERIENCE

AI Threat Validation Analyst | CyberMSI | Remote

May 2026 – Present

- Perform 24/7 SOC monitoring, including shifts as the sole analyst on duty with no L1/L2/L3 tiering, investigating, triaging, validating, and responding to incidents using Microsoft Defender XDR, MDE, MDO, MDCA, and Microsoft Threat Intelligence to determine scope, impact, and root cause.
- Correlate endpoint, identity, email, and cloud alerts to identify true-positive incidents; execute response actions including device isolation, threat containment, and IOC blocking, and recommend remediation to minimize business impact.
- Manage assigned Jira tickets end-to-end — from initial customer message through investigation and remediation to final resolution — including direct communication with customers throughout.
- Investigate phishing campaigns, malicious emails, URLs, IPs, and file hashes; apply the MITRE ATT&CK framework to map adversary tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs).
- Draft comprehensive incident summaries using the 5Ws (Who, What, When, Where, Why), documenting investigation findings, evidence, impact assessment, and response actions for accurate reporting.
- Support the team in investigating and troubleshooting detection playbook failures, helping identify gaps and improve response automation reliability.
- Coordinate shift handovers directly with the incoming analyst to ensure continuous 24/7 coverage, and maintain documentation/knowledge articles to support SLA compliance and audit readiness.

PROJECTS

ShadowSentinel AI — Real-Time AI-Powered Cyber Guardian Bot

- Architected an AI-driven SOC bot integrating Wazuh SIEM with a Large Language Model (LangChain) for automated alert summarization, contextual threat classification, and severity scoring, reducing manual tier-1 analyst workload.
- Implemented automated IP blocking via firewall rule injection, eliminating manual response lag for high-confidence threat detections in real time.
- Built facial recognition-based authentication, voice-activated alert delivery, and a covert stealth monitoring mode for Advanced Persistent Threat (APT) tracking scenarios.

SIEM with Microsoft Azure Sentinel — Cloud SOC Honeypot

- Deployed a deliberately vulnerable Windows VM on Azure with open RDP to simulate real-world attack surfaces, capturing live brute-force, credential-stuffing, and port-scan attempts.
- Integrated Azure Sentinel via Log Analytics Workspace with custom GeoIP watchlists to attribute attacks by country and visualize global threat actor activity on KQL-powered dashboards.
- Demonstrated full cloud SOC detection lifecycle: log ingestion, alert rule creation, incident triage, and geolocation-based threat attribution in a live environment.

SIEM with Wazuh on Linode/Akamai — Open-Source Host Security Monitoring

- Deployed and configured Wazuh SIEM across distributed endpoints to monitor file integrity, registry modifications, active IP connections, and real-time vulnerability detection.
- Centralized syslog forwarding, enrolled Wazuh agents, and built automated alerting workflows to enable host-level intrusion detection and rapid incident escalation.

Sign Language Recognition — ML Gesture Classification (EXSEL)

- Designed and trained a scikit-learn classification pipeline to recognize 8 hand gestures (A–F, I Love You, Best Of Luck) from image inputs, achieving high prediction accuracy on unseen data.
- Applied OpenCV for image preprocessing and feature extraction, promoting digital accessibility for hearing-impaired users through precise gesture-to-text translation.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology — Computer Science & Engineering Kalasalingam University, Krishnankoil, Tamil Nadu | Sep 2021 – May 2025

Intermediate (MPC) Krishna Murthy IIT & NEET Academy, Nellore, AP | Jun 2018 – Jul 2021

Secondary Education (10th Grade) Narayana Olympiad School, Nellore, AP | May 2019

CERTIFICATIONS & ACHIEVEMENTS

Certifications: Cisco Certified Cyber Essentials | IBM Security Learning Services | Mastercard Cybersecurity Job Simulation | Introduction to Ethical Hacking | CyberLab Security Training | Software Testing — Kumaraguru College of Technology

Hackathons & Events: KAVACH-2k23 National Hackathon | Encryptcon 24-Hr Hackathon (IIT Madras) | FantomCode'23 | RVIT Hackathon | Mobile App Development Workshop